

Alyssa René Heinze

alyssaheinze.github.io

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor, University of California-Davis Department of Political Science	starting 2027
Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford University King Center on Global Development	2026–27

EDUCATION

PhD in Political Science, University of California-Berkeley	2026
MSc in Economics, <i>Mention très bien</i> , Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne	2021
BA in Government, <i>Summa cum laude</i> , Dartmouth College	2018

ARTICLES

3. “Democratic Deepening or Elite Persistence? How Local Elites Adapt to Electoral Reform in Rural India.” *American Political Science Review* (2025, FirstView).
 - Paula D. McClain Award for the MPSA Best Paper (2025)
 - MPSA Evan Ringquist Field Award for Best Paper on the Topic of Political Institutions (2025)
 - Philo Sherman Bennett Prize in Political Science (2024)
 - Honorable Mention, Center for the Study of Law and Society Paper Prize (2024)
2. “Inclusive Reforms as Levers for Social Exclusion: The Paradoxical Consequences of Quotas for Women in Rural India.” *World Development* 196 (2025), with Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.
1. “Who Actually Governs? Gender Inequality and Political Representation in Rural India.” *The Journal of Politics* 87.2 (2025): 818–822, with Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.

BOOK PROJECT

Agriculture and Patriarchy: Growing and Severing the Roots of Male Dominance.

WORKING PAPERS

“When Crises Entrench Gendered Power: Male Elite Adaptation in the Ugandan Parliament”
R&R, with Cecilia Josefsson, Pär Zetterberg, and Amanda Clayton.

“Can Climate Change Disrupt Male Dominance?”
Draft available upon request.

“Flipping the Script: Restructuring Deliberation in Patriarchal Political Institutions.”
With Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.

“Decentralizing Democratic Erosion: Local Election Delays in the World’s Largest Democracy.”
With Pratik Mahajan.

SELECTED PROJECTS IN PROGRESS

“Feminized Victimhood: The Political Consequences of Global South Vulnerability in Climate Policy.”
Data collected, with Allison Grossman and Leonardo Arriola.

“Piped Water and Gender Empowerment: Evidence From a Downstream RCT in Urban India.”

Data collection in progress, with Nikhar Gaikwad and Anjali Thomas.

“Women Leaders, Solidarity, and Ecological Governance: RCT Evidence from Rural Telangana.”

Data collection in progress, with Rachel E. Brulé and Bhumi Purohit.

AWARDS

- 2025 The Empirical Study of Gender (EGEN) Research Prize
- 2024 Paula D. McClain Award for the MPSA Best Paper
- 2024 Evan Ringquist Field Award for Best Paper on the Topic of Political Institutions
- 2024 Odegard Award for the 3rd-Year Student with Exceptional Performance
- 2024 Philo Sherman Bennett Prize in Political Science

GRANTS

- 2024 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: \$20,000
- APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant: \$14,368
- Fulbright-Hays Doctoral Dissertation Research Abroad Fellowship: \$36,444
- Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics Travel Grant: \$4,698
- Global Democracy Commons Pilot Research Project Grant: \$2,000
- CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: \$20,000
- Bhattacharya Graduate Fellowship Travel Grant: \$1,000
- ABD Fellowship in International Studies: \$15,000
- 2023 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: \$5,000
- Pre-Dissertation Grant in International Studies: \$5,000
- 2022 Bhattacharya Graduate Fellowship Travel Grant: \$1,000
- CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: \$4,965
- 2021 BU Foundation-India Seed Funding: \$30,000 (with R. Brulé and B. Purohit)
- 2020 James B. Reynolds Scholarship for Masters Study: \$25,000
- Richard D. Lombard Public Service Research Fellowship: \$20,000
- 2018 Fulbright-Nehru Research Fellowship: \$20,000
- Fulbright Critical Language Enhancement Award for Marathi Studies: \$6,600
- Neil T. McGorrian Fellowship for Marathi Studies: \$5,500
- Honors Thesis Grant from the Office of President Hanlon: \$1,000
- Nelson A. Rockefeller Center Honors Thesis Grant: \$1,000
- Undergraduate Advising and Research Honors Thesis Grant: \$1,000

CONFERENCES AND INVITED TALKS

2026 (planned): Empirical Study of Gender Research Network Annual Conference (Stanford); MPSA Annual Conference & Three Decades of Research on India’s Gender Quotas Conference-within-a-conference (Chicago); Northeast Workshop in Empirical Political Science (NEWEPS); Gender and Political Polarization Workshop (Johns Hopkins); Penn: The Center for the Advanced Study of India Political Economy Workshop; EGEN / SUCCESS Conference (Bergen); European Conference on Politics and Gender (Newcastle); European Political Science Society Annual Conference (Belfast); APSA Annual Meeting (Boston); Conference on the Political Economy of Climate and Environment (PECE) (Harvard); Pre-APSA South Asia Political Economy of Development Workshop (Harvard)

2025: MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); APSA Annual Meeting (Vancouver); University of California, Davis; New York University, Abu Dhabi; University of Wisconsin, Madison

2024: Keynote Speaker, International Electoral Affairs Symposium (Jodhpur, India); European Conference on Politics and Gender (Ghent); MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); APSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia)
2023: APSA Annual Meeting (Los Angeles); African Studies Association Annual Meeting (San Francisco)
2022: MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); Resource and Support Centre for Development Speaker Series (Mumbai, India)

TEACHING

UC Berkeley

Graduate Student Instructor

PS236B Quantitative Methodology in the Social Sciences: From Samples to Populations, PhD (2024)
PS231C Model-based Inference and Machine Learning, PhD (2023)
PS231B Design and Causal Inference, PhD (2023)
PS3 Introduction to Empirical Analysis and Quantitative Methods, Undergraduate (2022)

Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP)

Co-Instructor

Learning Days, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)
Training of the Trainers for Learning Days, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire (2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)
Session on Estimation in R, remote (2024)
Refresher on Statistical Power, remote (2022)

SERVICE

Reviewer: *British Journal of Political Science*; *Comparative Political Studies*; *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; *The Journal of Politics*; National Science Foundation.

Convener: EPSS Belfast Pre-Conference Workshop: "The Politics of South Asia" (planned, 2026), with Aliz Tóth and Simon Chauchard

Other: EGAP Learning Days participant selection, training of the trainers, and instructor (2022–2026), EGAP Priority Theme Grant editing support (2022), EGAP Global Fellowship Graduate Mentor (2022)

May 2026